

Grammar: Parallel Structure

When a sentence includes a list, words in the list should be the same part of speech. Use two or more nouns, adjectives, or verbs, but do not mix these parts of speech.

Though London in 1900 was quite different from London in 2000, important similarities existed in population, employment, and transportation. (three nouns)

Summers in Miami are long, hot, and humid. (three adjectives)

Phrases and clauses in a list should also be parallel.

Survey results can be misleading because there is a huge difference between what people think they do and what they actually do. (two noun clauses)

Sweden is a family-friendly country because of its paid parental leave, generous monthly payments for children, and free preschool education. (three noun phrases)

To prepare for a test, students should review their notes, find a study partner, and get a good night's sleep. (three verb phrases)

PRACTICE 1 Identifying and Creating Parallelism

- A** Underline the items or ideas in each sentence that are in parallel form. Circle the word(s) that connect the parallel structures.

2. You know you are truly fluent in another language when you can calculate in it and when you begin to dream in it.
5. My new personal computer is both fast and reliable.
8. Young people buy computers not only to do schoolwork but also to play games.
9. If industrial nations continue to burn fossil fuels and if developing nations continue to burn their rain forests, the level of CO₂ in the atmosphere will continue to increase.
10. Before the judge announced the punishment, he asked the murderer if he wanted to speak either to the victim's family or to the jury.



ACTIVITY 8

If an underlined part of a sentence below is incorrect, write a correction above it.

1. The most expensive items in this company's budget are employee salaries, communication costs, and spend money on office supplies.

1. You do not need to risk carrying cash or to risk to miss a sale.

You do not need to risk carrying cash or missing a sale.

2. Credit cards are accepted by department stores, airlines, and they can be used in some gas stations.

3. The disadvantages of using a credit card are overspending and you pay high interest rates.

4. With credit cards, you can either pay your bill with one check, or you can stretch out your payments.

5. You can charge both at restaurants and when you stay at hotels.

6. Many people carry not only credit cards but they also carry cash.

7. Many people want neither to pay off their balance monthly nor do they like paying interest.

8. Not making any payment or to send in only the minimum payment every month is poor money management.



ACTICE 7

Writing Parallel Structures

Complete each sentence with words or phrases that repeat the grammatical form of the italicized words. Look at the writing models on pages 65–69 as needed.

1. The rural Irish were uneducated, poor, and hungry.
adjective
2. They lived in shacks, shared living quarters, and _____.
3. People began to clean up the cities, _____, and _____.
4. The poor Irish became desperate, hoping to find work, _____, and _____.
5. The streets of the big cities in the U.S. were dirty, _____ and _____.



TRY IT OUT!

On a separate sheet of paper, combine the sentences in each group in any logical way to make one sentence. Your final sentence may be simple, compound, or complex. Look for opportunities to make adjective clauses. You may add, delete, or change words, but you must not omit any information or change the meaning.

SET 1:

The United Nations maintains peace.
The peace is international.
The United Nations helps countries.
The countries need aid.
The aid is humanitarian.

SET 2:

There is a garbage patch.
It is in the Pacific Ocean.
It is full of plastic.
The plastic was brought there by ocean currents.

SET 3

3. A home can be damaged.

The damage can be permanent.

The damage is caused by hurricane-force winds.

SET 4

Using cell phones is disruptive.

Using cell phones is disrespectful.

People use cell phones during meetings.

SET 5

Oksana Masters was born in Ukraine in 1989.

She had severe physical problems.

Now she is an outstanding American athlete.

She competes in cross-country skiing and cycling.

SET 6

Researchers plan to design a wind turbine.

It will be taller than the Eiffel Tower.

It will have 650-foot (198-meter) blades.

It could reduce the cost of wind power by 50 percent.

Task: Complete the following sentences with your own ideas.

1. Life in the city is much more interesting than life in the country. For one thing,
(For example,)

2. A positive work environment may contribute

3. Lack of physical activity can be very harmful. This is particularly the case for

4. Electric cars do not cause air pollution. In addition,

5. Children in small families get a lot of adult attention. On the other hand,

TEMPLATE OF A PARAGRAPH WITH BOTH SIMILARITIES AND DIFFERENCES

There are both similarities and differences between [A] and [B], and each has its own advantages and disadvantages. **This paragraph will first discuss the similarities between the two before moving on to their main differences.**

To begin with, [A] and [B] are similar in several ways. One important similarity is that they both In addition, not only [A] but also [B], which means that

However, despite these similarities, there are also some clear differences between the two.

To begin with, [A] is generally different from [B] in [aspect 1]. [A]....., whereas [B] tends to be As a result, Another noticeable difference can be seen in [aspect 2]. While [A]....., [B] This shows that

In conclusion, although both [A] and [B] share some similarities, I believe that [A / B] is the better choice because

TEMPLATE OF A PARAGRAPH WITH DIFFERENCES

There are several clear differences between [A] and [B], and this paragraph will analyse these differences by focusing on [aspect 1], [aspect 2], and [aspect 3].

To begin with, [A] is generally different from B in [aspect 1]. [A]....., whereas [B] tends to be As a result,

Another noticeable difference can be seen in [aspect 2]. While [A]....., [B] This shows that

In addition, [aspect 3] is also an important point of contrast. [A] usually, yet [B] which may be more suitable for

In conclusion, although both [A] and [B] have their advantages, I personally believe that [A / B] is the better choice because

TEMPLATE OF A PROBLEM PARAGRAPH

[Clearly stating the issue.] This gives rise to several significant problems.

[.....] is the primary problem that needs addressing. This issue has led to.....

Another issue that arises from..... is that **[.....]**. One major impact of this is Furthermore, **[.....]**. Failure to address this problem may result in..... It is vital that those mentioned problems be addressed by.....soon. Otherwise, if this trend continues, there is a likelihood that

Template of a paragraph with (CAUSES/PROBLEMS) – SOLUTIONS PARAGRAPH

The issue of _____ has become more serious in recent years and affects many people.

(To begin with, it is important to understand the main causes/problems related to this issue. One major cause/problem of this is _____, which leads to _____. Another problem/cause is _____, and this makes the situation worse because _____.)

However, more attention should be paid to the solutions that can help deal with this issue. One effective solution is to _____. This would help because _____. For example, _____. Another important solution is _____. By doing this, _____, which can reduce the problem in the long term. In addition, _____ could also be encouraged so that _____.

In conclusion, although _____ causes serious problems, practical solutions such as _____ and _____ can make a positive difference.